West Bund Art & Design Fair
Shanghai
BOOTH N316 | NOVEMBER 7-10, 2019



For the gallery's first participation at the Westbund Art & Design Fair, Shanghai, we present seminal works by the American artist **MARK TOBEY** (1890-1976), shown at the gallery for the first time in 1945, as well as the Cantonese artist **YANG JIECHANG** (b. 1956), shown at the gallery for the first time in 1989. This year, Yang Jiechang is celebrating his 30th anniversary of collaboration with the French gallery.

Both artists, from West to East for Mark Tobey and from East to West for Yang Jiechang have had a spiritual path throughout their work.

MARK TOBEY

1890 - 1976



Untitled, 1959, tempera on wooden board, 34,6 x 43 cm, Courtesy Galerie Jeanne Bucher Jaeger, Paris.

Born in 1890 Centerville, Wisconsin, **Mark Tobey** studied at the Art Institute in Chicago and converted to the Baha'i faith in 1918, whose teachings emphasize the oneness of all religions, people and aspects of the world which had a profound effect on his work. After moving to Seattle, he was initiated to calligraphy by his Chinese student Teng Kwei. The artist is now recognized as a vanguard figure, whose work anticipated the formal innovations of the New York School with artists such as Jackson Pollock. Mark Tobey's unique style uses most of the time tempera paintings with an *all-over* composition, creating a unique style of abstract painting. After furthering his knowledge of calligraphy in Persia, Tobey traveled extensively through China and Japan in the 1930's which would prove the foundation of his mature work. He states: « *it was there that I got what I call the calligraphic impulse to carry my work on into some new spiritual dimensions; I painted the frenetic rhythms of modern cities, the interweaving light and the streams of people entangled in a big world net.* » He deployed it beautifully in his special series of white writing. His artistic career is entirely tied to his spiritual journey, and he is known as the artist who reconciled East and West in his work. Mark Tobey is represented through a group of essential 10 works ranging from 1954 to 1970.



Untitled, 1961, monotype on paper, 99 x 50 cm
Courtesy Galerie Jeanne Bucher Jaeger, Paris